

Retained Developer — Engagement Brief

Senior full-stack developer, retained contract, three to five days per month.

THE COMPANY AND THE ESTATE

EDM Holdings is a Dubai-based fit-out and drywall subcontractor working for Tier-1 main contractors. The business runs a purpose-built digital estate: a 20-page website, a suite of browser-based site tools (takeoff, QA evidence, daily records, progress, cashflow and a group operations board), and EDM OS — a CRM and operations platform built on Next.js 14, NestJS, PostgreSQL and Docker, source-complete with 37 routes and 52 passing unit tests, not yet run in production. The entire stack is TypeScript.

THE ENGAGEMENT

- Retained contractor, three to five days per month, deliverable-based. Remote acceptable; Dubai time overlap required.
- All intellectual property created under the engagement is assigned to EDM Holdings without exception.
- All code resides in repositories owned and controlled by EDM Holdings. The developer receives access; EDM holds the keys, including deployment credentials and admin accounts held by a named second person inside the business.
- Documentation is part of every deliverable — the system must survive a change of developer.

FIRST NINETY DAYS — IN ORDER

- One. Stand up EDM OS in production with live data on a single pilot project: hosting, nightly backups, access control, and a tested restore. Nothing else starts until this is running.
- Two. Take custody: repository structure, deployment runbook, environment documentation, credential handover completed and verified.
- Three. Build the commercial pipeline layer — enquiry-to-tender pipeline board, tender tracker with win/loss capture, and main-contractor payment scoring fed from claims data. Built multi-tenant-ready: no client-specific hardcoding, clean data separation.

THE PERSON

- Senior: has run production systems solo and carries the scars — backups, security, and boring reliability over clever features.
- Strong across the existing stack: TypeScript, Next.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL, Docker.
- Communicates in plain English with non-technical directors; comfortable being the only technical person in the room.

SUCCESS AT DAY NINETY

EDM OS live on one real project with daily use and verified backups; full custody documented and tested; the pipeline layer in build against a written spec. Measured, not promised.